Teaching Statement

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Teaching Approach

I see the unique value of an economics education as teaching students the economic way of thinking – taking messy, ill-defined situations, characterizing them with simple models, testing those models against evidence, and optimizing strategies against model predictions. This methodology applies far outside of economics, providing value to students regardless of discipline, as ambiguous problems exist in all fields. This analytical paradigm extends into more specialized classes by introducing students to new problems, developing more complex models, and presenting new techniques to verify models, all the while conveying field-specific knowledge.

To facilitate this learning, my approach to teaching relies on three pillars: conveying theoretical foundations, learning through application, and facilitating independent inquiry. Students are introduced to theory through lectures and readings; they gain experience working through an application of the theory, such as a problem set or in-class experiment; and students learn to apply the conclusions by working on independent projects and presentations. Encountered limitations of the theory then lead into the next lesson. This approach can be applied to both lecture-heavy and project-heavy courses. Time allocation can be adjusted appropriately, but I believe retaining an applied project remains useful for reinforcing class lessons and providing students with an artifact they can point to.

Teaching Experience

Although I have yet to independently teach a course, I have co-instructed several courses, with my duties including course development, exam writing, delivering lectures, mentoring undergraduate project development, and providing individualized guidance on graduate paper-writing. I have found this work deeply meaningful and hope to have the opportunity to teach in the future.

Undergraduate Teaching

For undergraduate teaching, I have co-instructed a 300-level managerial economics course, in which students learn to apply the principles and lessons of game theory, economic reasoning, and experimental economics to the marketplace, translating theory into managerial decision-making. In teaching this course over the last three years, we have restructured the course as many times, seeking to optimize delivery by adjusting the density of theory per lecture, adding elements of an inverted classroom, and including experiments during class to build economic intuition before making theory increasingly complex. Adding in-class experiments has, according to informal interviews and students' comments, increased student engagement and self-reported learning. Thus, I plan to employ in-class experiments in my teaching going forward, especially at the undergraduate level. Another result of this experimentation has been a move from multiple co-equal projects, first to one major project with smaller side projects and then to one major project and in-class exams. While I still believe that project-based learning is indispensable for students, the emergence of eminently accessible artificial intelligence (AI)

tools has changed the nature of assessment – projects can be much more involved and complex, with students encouraged to employ AI, while independent offline assessments provide the direct incentive to master course material.

Undergraduate Research

Additionally, I have experience mentoring undergraduate students in conducting scientific research in economics, having mentored students in two summer-long research workshops, serving as a lecturer, advisor on project development, and technical mentor. Having myself attended these workshops as a participant before my graduate studies, I drew on my own prior experience to tailor my mentoring, specifically providing more structured feedback and tractable exploration steps. These workshops provided a unique opportunity, as undergraduate students were able to participate from the ground up in the development, implementation, and analysis of novel research in economics. Participating as an undergraduate motivated me to pursue the PhD, so I was excited to be able to provide such an opportunity to the next set of scholars, some of whom are now engaged in their own PhD studies.

Graduate Teaching

At the graduate level, I have co-instructed courses on experimental economics, computational methods, and causal microeconometrics. These classes, while all chiefly methodological, have offered me the opportunity to practice different aspects of teaching, with responsibilities varying by course. For the microeconometrics class, I delivered lectures, constructed exam questions, and provided individualized teaching and mentorship through office hours. For the experimental class, I delivered and developed lectures on experimental design and blockchains as examples of institutions, mentored students in developing research projects, and gave individual feedback on papers in the style of peer review. One of the papers improved during the Spring 2023 course led to a dissertation chapter, while my overall performance in delivering the most recent course was rated 4.6/5 by an anonymized census of its students. Finally, in the computational methods class, I delivered lectures on the technical details of programming in Python and versioning with Git. Additionally, I mentored students in developing their own computational models and research tools.

Teaching Interests

At the undergraduate level, I am fully prepared to teach the microeconomics sequence, institutional economics, law and economics, behavioral economics, experimental economics, and econometrics.

At the graduate level, I would be prepared to teach microeconomics, game theory, experimental economics, computational economics, law and economics, and applied microeconometrics.